



Homecoming: After going unsold twice at his base price of Rs. 75 lakh, Prithvi Shaw found his way back to familiar ground, with Delhi Capitals signing him for Rs. 75 lakh, rekindling a partnership that ran from 2018 to 2024. PTI

franchises spending Rs. 63.45 crore on them. That figure represents 72.59 per cent of the total spend on Indian players.

Eleven of those uncapped players earned more than their base price, many emerging from State T20 leagues. Robust scouting networks ensured names such as Prashant (UP T20 League), Akshat Raghuwanshi (MP Premier League), Mangesh (MP

T20 League), Tejasvi Singh Dahiya (Delhi Premier League), and Naman Tiwari (UP T20 League) were already well known before auction day.

This influx of State-league talent comes at a time when the IPL is witnessing higher scoring rates, flatter pitches, and shrinking margins for bowlers.

If pedigree and long domestic grind were once considered

essential, the success of players like Priyansh Arya, Digvesh Rathi, and Vipraj Nigam suggests otherwise.

As conditions become increasingly unforgiving, the sustained success of this new crop of T20 specialists could further establish the IPL as an alternative and effective pathway for elite talent, reinforcing its position as the global benchmark for the modern game.

Rs. 10 crore

Kartik Sharma and Prashant Veer — the youngest players ever to cross the figure at an auction

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Punjab Kings waited through these many players before making its first bid